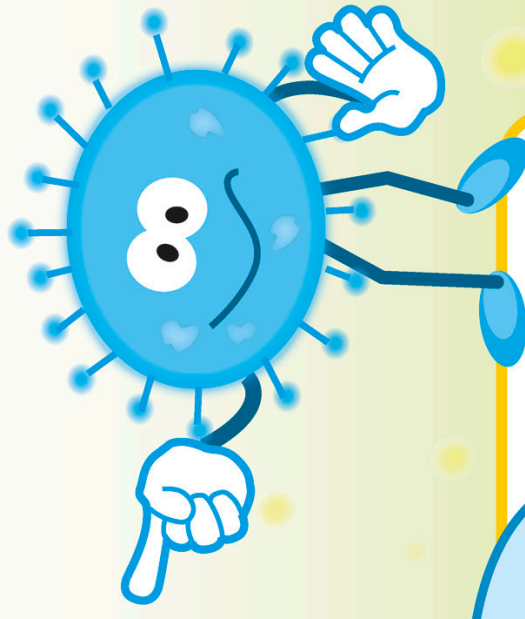


down to BASICS

The most BASIC UNIT OF LIFE is the CELL. Every living thing is made up of cells. The simplest is no more than a single cell while a human is made of an estimated *37 trillion cells* (and maybe as many as 724 trillion cells!).

There are *millions* of different types of *cells*. Each can take in *nutrients* to *provide itself* with *energy*, carry out *particular functions*, and replicate itself to form *new cells*.



CELL STRUCTURE

Cells fall into two groups: simple prokaryotes and complex eukaryotes.

Eukaryotes

Eukaryotes are complex cells found in plants, animals, and fungi. They are around 10 times larger than single-celled prokaryotes and contain small compartments called organelles—the cell's equivalent to our body's organs—that carry out the functions of the cell. The most important of these is the nucleus, which houses the cell's DNA.

